the name of the grouping should be known as BIMSTEC or the **Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation**.

The Chairmanship of BIMSTEC is done on a rotation basis. Table 20.4 gives the list of Chairmanship and years of assumption of the Chair by member countries.

The BIS-TEC or Bangkok Declaration, 1997, lays down the organizational arrangement of BIMSTEC. It comprises the Annual Ministerial Meeting to be hosted by member states on rotational basis according to the alphabetical order, Senior Officials Committee, A Working Group for preparatory works before each Annual Ministerial Meetings and Specialized Task Forces, which may be deemed necessary.

Table 21.4 List of Chairing BIMSTEC countries with year

Sl. No	*Countries*	*Year*
1.	Bangladesh	1997–1999
2.	India	2000–2001
3.	Myanmar	2001–2002
4.	Sri Lanka	2002–2003
5.	Thailand	2003–2005
6.	Bangladesh	2005–2006
7.	India*	2006–2009
8.	Myanmar	2009–2014
9.	Nepal	2014–2018
10.	Sri Lanka	2018–till date

*Bhutan skipped so Chairmanship turned to India.

BIMSTEC has identified six priority sectors at the 2nd Ministerial Meeting in Dhaka on 19 November 1998, and for each there is a 'lead country'. Trade and investment is under Bangladesh, technology under Sri Lanka, transport and communication under India, energy under Myanmar, tourism under India and fisheries under Thailand. After the 8th Ministerial Meeting in Dhaka on 18-19 December 2005, a number of new areas of cooperation emerged which include agriculture, public health, poverty alleviation, counter-terrorism and transnational crime, protection of